

Who Pays and Who Decides: The Decision

谁承担，谁决定：决定

Theme: 社会问题、经济与公共生活 · New: 44 · Review: 18 · Planned cumulative progress: 44/6,127

English Story

The decision was taken in a **flat** above a **retail** unit, and it answered a simple question: **how do we let a building fall** into use without selling the land? “The **role** of the council is to **occupy** the ground and to **halt** the sale,” the **advocate** said. “A **cheque** and a **poster** will not **rescue** a public service.”

The **understanding** in the room was that the **danger** was **ordinary** and the **emergency** was not. “We have a **warning** and we have a **fire** escape; what we **do** not have is a **necessity**,” the **narrator** of the meeting said. “A **tale** about **tradition** is not a plan, and a **guess** is not a **production** figure.”

The **sharp** part of the discussion was the **refusal** of the retailer. “We can **forgive** a delay and we cannot **forgive** a betrayal,” Maya wrote. “The **innocence** of a small shop does not **endanger** the water supply, and the **urgency** of the bank does not **liberate** the council.”

The **advocate** for the tenants proposed a **concerted** scheme: a **strip** of shops on a lease, a **flat** for the caretaker, and an **equivalence** between the old rate and the new one. “A **reformist** measure is worth more than a **supposition** about the future,” she said.

The vote was seven to five, and the effect was immediate. “We **do** not **immunize** a city against scarcity by depressing its rates,” the treasurer said. “We build a habit of paying.” The council would **occupy** the **building** within the year, and the sale would **halt** at the end of the term.

The real issue had been between two ways of holding power: to own or to steward. The activity of the council, its drive to build, and the support of the tenants had produced a decision that neither side could call a victory. Someone had to **weave** the two plans together, and only then would the order of the day become an act instead of a lie. The **advocacy** of the tenants was a promise not to **betray** them, and the **building** would not **sell** itself, and the only thing left was the vote.

中文翻译

决定是在一家零售店楼上的一间公寓里做出的，它回答了一个简单的问题：我们如何让一栋建筑投入使用而不卖掉土地？“议会的职责是占用这块地并中止出售，”拥护者说，“一张支票和一张海报救不了一项公共服务。”

屋里的共识是：危险是平常的，而紧急状态不是。“我们有警告，也有消防通道；我们没有的是必要性，”会议讲述者说。“一个关于传统的故事不是计划，一个猜测也不是产量数字。”

讨论中最尖锐的部分是零售商的拒绝。“我们可以原谅一次延误，却无法原谅一次背叛，”曼雅写道，“一家小店铺的无辜不会危及供水，而银行的紧迫也不会解放议会。”

租户的拥护者提出了一项商定的方案：一条带租约的商铺、一间给管理员的公寓，以及旧费率与新费率之间的等价。“一项改良主义的措施比一个关于未来的推测更有价值，”她说。

表决结果是七比五，影响立竿见影。“我们无法靠压低费率让一座城市对匮乏免疫，”司库说，“我们建立的是一种付钱的习惯。”议会将在年内占用那栋楼，而出售将在学期末中止。

真正的问题一直介于两种掌权方式之间：拥有，还是照管。议会的那场活动、它建设的动力，以及租户的支持，共同促成了一项双方都无法称之为胜利的决定。总得有人把两套方案编织在一起，只有这样，当日的议程才会变成一项行动，而不是一个谎言。租户的拥护是一份不背叛他们的承诺，而那栋楼不会自己卖掉自己，剩下的只有表决。

Core Vocabulary · 核心词汇

Word / Pronunciation	Context meaning / source example
do du: POS: v	v. 做, 进行, 完成 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. the syllable naming the first (tonic) note of any major scale in solmization; v. get (something) done; v. pr...
how hau POS: adv	adv. 如何, 怎样, 多少, 多么; n. 方式 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: adv. In what manner or way; by what means or process.; adv. To what degree or extent, number or amount; in wha...
let let POS: vt	vt. 让, 假设, 出租, 排放, 妨碍; vi. 出租, 被承包; n. 出租屋, 障碍 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a serve that strikes the net before falling into the receiver's court; the ball must be served again; v. ma...
fall fo:l POS: n	n. 落下, 瀑布, 采伐量, 下降, 落差, 降低, 堕落, 秋天; vi. 倒下, 落下, 来临, 失守, 阵亡, 下跌, 减弱, 倾斜... Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. the season when the leaves fall from the trees; n. the lapse of mankind into sinfulness because of the sin...
building 'bildɪŋ POS: n	n. 建筑物, 建筑; [法] 营造, 建筑, 建筑物 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a structure that has a roof and walls and stands more or less permanently in one place; n. the occupants of...
sell sel POS: vt	vt. 卖, 背叛, 销售, 出卖; vi. 卖, 销售; n. 卖, 推销术, 失望 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. the activity of persuading someone to buy; v. exchange or deliver for money or its equivalent; v. be sold at...
role rəʊl POS: n	n. 角色, 职责, 任务; [医] 作用, 功用 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. normal or customary activity of a person in a particular social setting
production prə'dʌkʃən POS: n	n. 制造, 生产, 产物; [医] 产生, 生成 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. the act or process of producing something; n. a presentation for the stage or screen or radio or television...
fire 'faɪə POS: n	n. 火, 炉火, 电炉, 火灾, 闪光体, 炮火, 热情; vt. 点燃, 烧制, 使发光, 激动, 放枪, 解雇; vi. 着火, 烧火, ... Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. the event of something burning (often destructive); n. the act of firing weapons or artillery at an enemy; n...
guess ges POS: n	n. 猜测, 臆测; v. 猜测, 臆测 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a message expressing an opinion based on incomplete evidence; n. an estimate based on little or no informat...
tradition trə'dɪʃən POS: n	n. 传说, 传统, 交付; [法] 传统, 惯例, 移交 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. an inherited pattern of thought or action
understanding ,ʌnde'stændɪŋ POS: n	n. 理解, 谅解; [法] 协商, 协议, 谅解 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. the cognitive condition of someone who understands; s. characterized by understanding based on comprehensio...
danger 'deɪndʒə POS: n	n. 危险, 威胁; [法] 危险, 危险物, 危机 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. the condition of being susceptible to harm or injury; n. a cause of pain or injury or loss; n. a dangerous p...
ordinary 'ɔ:dɪnəri POS: a	a. 平常的, 普通的, 平凡的; n. 平常的人(或事) Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a judge of a probate court; n. the expected or commonplace condition or situation; n. a clergyman appointed...
flat flæt POS: a	a. 平坦的, 单调的, 无力的, 浅的, 萧条的, 干脆的, 无聊的; adv. 平直地, 断然地; n. 扁平物, 平面, 平地, 平原, ... Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a level tract of land; n. a shallow box in which seedlings are started; n. a musical notation indicating one...
emergency 'ɪmə:dʒənsɪ POS: n	n. 紧急状况, 紧急事件, 紧急需要; [化] 紧急情况 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a sudden unforeseen crisis (usually involving danger) that requires immediate action; n. a state in which m...
warning 'wɔ:nɪŋ POS: n	n. 警告, 预告, 预兆, 通知; [法] 警告, 警戒, 预告; 警告的, 注意的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a message informing of danger; n. notification of something, usually in advance
occupy 'ɒkjʊpaɪ POS: vt	vt. 占领, 占(时间、空间等), 住进, 担任, 使从事, 使全神贯注; [法] 占领, 占据, 占有 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: v. live (in a certain place); v. occupy the whole of
sharp ʃɑ:p POS: n	n. 半升音调, 利刃, 骗子; a. 锋利的, 明显的, 敏锐的, 急剧的, 尖刻的, 严厉的, 刺耳的, 精明的; adv. 锐利地, 急... Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a musical notation indicating one half step higher than the note named; n. a long thin sewing needle with a...
tale teɪl POS: n	n. 故事, 谎言, 谣言, 陈述, 叙述; [法] 虚语, 诽谤, 谣言 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n a message that tells the particulars of an act or occurrence or course of events; presented in writing or d...

Word / Pronunciation	Context meaning / source example
advocate 'ædvəkeɪt POS: n	n. 提倡者, 拥护者; vt. 主张, 提倡 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a person who pleads for a cause or propounds an idea; n. a lawyer who pleads cases in court
cheque tʃek POS: n	n. 支票 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: v. withdraw money by writing a check
strip stri:p POS: n	n. 长条, 条状, 带, 脱衣舞; vt. 脱衣, 被剥去, 剥夺, 拆卸; vi. 脱衣服 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a relatively long narrow piece of something; n. artifact consisting of a narrow flat piece of material; n. t...
necessity nɪ'sesəti POS: n	n. 需要, 必需品, 必然; [法] 必要性, 必然性, 必要 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. the condition of being essential or indispensable; n. anything indispensable
forgive fə'gɪv POS: vt	vt. 原谅, 宽恕, 免除; [法] 免除, 宽恕, 原谅 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: v. stop blaming or grant forgiveness; v. absolve from payment
retail 'ri:teɪl POS: n	n. 零售; a. 零售的; vt. 零售, 详述, 传播; vi. 零售 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. the selling of goods to consumers; usually in small quantities and not for resale; v. be sold at the retail...
refusal rɪ'fju:zl POS: n	n. 拒绝, 推却, 优先决定权; [法] 拒绝, 谢绝, 取舍权 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. the act of refusing; n. a message refusing to accept something that is offered
rescue 'reskjʊ: POS: n	n. 援救, 解救, 营救; vt. 援救, 救出, 营救 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. recovery or preservation from loss or danger; v. free from harm or evil; v. take forcibly from legal custody
poster 'peustə POS: n	n. 海报, 招贴, 驿马 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a sign posted in a public place as an advertisement
halt hɔ:lt POS: n	n. 停止, 立定, 休息; vt. 使停止, 使立定; vi. 立定, 停止, 蹒跚, 踌躇, 有缺点; [计] 停止 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: v. cause to stop
weave wi:v POS: n	n. 编法, 织法, 编织式样; vt. 编织, 组合, 编排, 使迂回前进; vi. 纺织, 迂回行进 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. pattern of weaving or structure of a fabric; v. interlace by or as if by weaving; v. create a piece of cloth...
narrator phonetic unavailable POS: n	n. 讲述者, 叙述者; [法] 陈述者, 叙述者 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. someone who tells a story
betray bi'trei POS: vt	vt. 出卖, 背叛, 辜负, 暴露; [法] 出卖, 背叛, 泄露 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: v. reveal unintentionally; v. deliver to an enemy by treachery
advocacy 'ædvəkəsi POS: n	n. 拥护, 支持, 鼓吹, 辩护, 辩护术; [法] 辩护, 拥护, 提倡 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. active support of an idea or cause etc.; especially the act of pleading or arguing for something
innocence 'ɪnəsəns POS: n	n. 无罪, 无知, 天真无邪; [法] 无罪, 无罪的人, 清白无辜者 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a state or condition of being innocent of a specific crime or offense
urgency 'æ:dʒənsɪ POS: n	n. 紧急, 催促; [法] 紧急, 迫切, 紧急之事 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. the state of being urgent; an earnest and insistent necessity; n. pressing importance requiring speedy action...
endanger ɪn'deɪndʒə POS: vt	vt. 危及; [法] 使危险, 危及 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: v. pose a threat to; present a danger to
liberate 'libereɪt POS: vt	vt. 解放, 释放, 使自由; [机] 释出, 放出 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: v. grant freedom to
depress di'pres POS: vt	vt. 使沮丧, 压低, 降低, 使萧条; [化] 推下 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: v. lower someone's spirits; make downhearted; v. lower (prices or markets); v. lessen the activity or force of
concerted kən'sə:tɪd POS: a	a. 商定的, 协定的, 一致的; [法] 一致的, 协力的, 共同的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: s. involving the joint activity of two or more
equivalence i'kwɪvələns POS: n	n. 同等, 等价, 等值; [计] 等价 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. essential equality and interchangeability
supposition ,sʌpe'zɪʃən POS: n	n. 想像, 推测, 推想; [法] 假定, 推定, 推测 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. the cognitive process of supposing
reformist rɪ'fɔ:mɪst POS: n	n. 改良主义者, 改革者 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n a disputant who advocates reform; s favoring or promoting reform (often by government action)

Word / Pronunciation	Context meaning / source example
immunize 'imju:naiz POS: vt	vt. 使免疫, 赋予免疫性 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: v. law: grant immunity from prosecution; v. perform vaccinations or produce immunity in by inoculation